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Deformable surface patch unit

Abstract

A surface repair patch unit is disclosed. The patch unit may include a deformable Thermoplastic Polyurethane (TPU) sheet and a deformable adhesive mesh sheet. The deformable adhesive mesh sheet may be attached or fused to the TPU sheet such that the TPU sheet may be disposed on a mesh sheet interior surface. The patch unit may be configured to be adhered to a damaged surface via the deformable adhesive mesh sheet, and the TPU sheet may substantially cover the damaged surface. The patch unit may further include a first protective film and a second protective film that may be removably attached to patch unit opposing surfaces, and may protect the opposing surfaces from ambient environment.

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Background/Summary**TECHNICAL FIELD**

(1) The present disclosure relates to a surface patch unit, and more specifically to a flexible surface patch unit having a deformable Thermoplastic Polyurethane (TPU) sheet that may be adhered to surfaces of different shapes.

BACKGROUND

(2) Drywalls or surfaces made of wood, fiberglass or board generally get damaged due to wear and tear and regular usage. Users may replace affected surface with a new surface when the damage is substantial. However, in most cases, the damage due to wear and tear is repairable, and the users typically use surface repair patches to repair the damage, and/or apply drywall compound (e.g.,

cement or quickset plaster) over the damaged surface portion.

(3) A conventional drywall repair patch uses a metal plate that may be adhered to the drywall over the damaged portion by using an adhesive mesh material. A user may apply the drywall compound over the metal plate when the patch is adhered to the drywall, thus enabling repair of damaged portion.

(4) While the metal plate may provide strength and structural integrity to the repair patch, the metal plate is generally not flexible, and hence cannot be used to repair damages on curved surfaces or drywall corners. Further, the metal plate typically has a different coefficient of thermal expansion than respective coefficients of the adhesive mesh material and/or drywall material. Thus, the metal plate may expand or contract at a different rate than the adhesive mesh and the drywall, when the repair patch heats or cools due to fluctuations in ambient temperature. This may result in cracking of repaired drywall portion over time.

(5) Furthermore, repair patches with metal plates typically have standard/fixed dimensions and may not be customized. Therefore, such repair patches may have limited utility in repairing damaged drywall portions of different dimensions. For example, a conventional metal plate-based repair patch of square shape may not be useful in repairing an elongated damaged drywall portion (e.g., along a length of a drywall corner).

(6) Thus, there is a need for a surface repair patch that may be customizable, flexible and may not develop cracks over time.

(7) It is with respect to these and other considerations that the disclosure made herein is presented.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The detailed description is set forth with reference to the accompanying drawings. The use of the same reference numerals may indicate similar or identical items. Various embodiments may utilize elements and/or components other than those illustrated in the drawings, and some elements and/or components may not be present in various embodiments. Elements and/or components in the figures are not necessarily drawn to scale. Throughout this disclosure, depending on the context, singular and plural terminology may be used interchangeably.

(2) FIG. 1 depicts an example environment in which techniques and structures for providing the systems and methods disclosed herein may be implemented.

(3) FIG. 2 depicts an example surface repair patch unit in accordance with the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 3A depicts an isometric view of a surface and the surface repair patch unit of FIG. 2 adhered over the surface, in accordance with the present disclosure.

(5) FIG. 3B depicts an example snapshot of a memory feature of the surface repair patch unit of FIG. 2 in accordance with the present disclosure.

(6) FIG. 4 depicts examples of packaged surface repair patch units in accordance with the present disclosure.

(7) FIG. 5 depicts an example surface patch unit in accordance with the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) Overview

(9) The present disclosure is directed towards a flexible patch unit that may be adhered to a surface. The patch unit may be, for example, a surface repair patch unit that may be adhered over a damaged portion (e.g., a crack or a hole) of a drywall. A user may apply drywall compound over the patch unit after adhering the patch unit to the drywall surface. In some aspects, the patch unit may include a deformable Thermoplastic Polyurethane (TPU) sheet and a deformable adhesive mesh sheet. The TPU sheet may be attached to the adhesive mesh sheet, and the patch unit may be adhered to the drywall surface via the adhesive mesh sheet. The TPU sheet may substantially cover

the damaged portion when the user adheres the patch unit to the drywall surface.

(10) In other aspects, the TPU sheet and the adhesive mesh sheet may be fused together during patch unit manufacturing process to form an integrated unified sheet. In this case, one surface (e.g., an interior surface) of the integrated unified sheet may include adhesive material, and the integrated unified sheet may be adhered to the drywall surface via the interior surface. Further, an opposing surface (e.g., an exterior surface) of the integrated unified sheet may be non-adhesive, and the user may apply drywall compound over the exterior surface when the integrated unified sheet is adhered to the drywall surface over the damaged portion.

(11) In another aspect, the patch unit may include the TPU sheet, but may not include the adhesive mesh sheet. In this case, a TPU sheet interior surface may include the adhesive material, and the user may directly adhere the TPU sheet to the drywall surface via the TPU sheet interior surface. In this case, a TPU sheet exterior surface may be non-adhesive, and the user may apply the drywall compound over the TPU sheet exterior surface when the TPU sheet is adhered to the drywall surface.

(12) In yet another aspect, the patch unit may include the TPU sheet and a textile sheet. In this case, both the TPU sheet exterior and interior surfaces may include adhesive material, and the textile sheet may be attached to the TPU sheet exterior surface. The textile sheet may have greater thickness than TPU sheet thickness, and the patch unit including the textile sheet may act as a childproof surface patch that may be adhered to drywall surface portions that may be more prone to impacts (e.g., surface corners). In further aspects, the patch unit may include additional reinforcement layers (e.g., of plastic or fiberglass) in between the TPU sheet and the textile sheet to increase patch unit thickness and provide additional cushion to the childproof surface.

(13) The present disclosure discloses a patch unit that may enable the user to repair a damaged surface portion. Since the patch unit is made of flexible sheets, the patch unit may be adhered to curved surfaces or corners. Further, since the patch unit includes the TPU sheet that may have a low coefficient of thermal expansion, the patch unit may not expand (or contract) considerably when ambient temperature fluctuates. This may ensure that repaired surface portion (including the patch unit) may not develop cracks over time. Further, the patch unit may have customizable dimensions and the user may conveniently cut the patch unit to a desired dimension by using a pair of scissors. This may enable the user to use the patch unit to repair damaged portions of varying shapes and dimensions.

(14) These and other advantages of the present disclosure are provided in detail herein.

Illustrative Embodiments

(15) The disclosure will be described more fully hereinafter with reference to the accompanying drawings, in which example embodiments of the disclosure are shown, and not intended to be limiting.

(16) FIG. 1 depicts an example environment **100** in which techniques and structures for providing the systems and methods disclosed herein may be implemented. The environment **100** may include a surface **105** that may be a drywall, a wooden surface, a furniture surface, a plastic surface, a glass surface, a fiberglass surface, a board, and/or the like. The surface **105** may include a damaged portion **110** that may require repair, shown in view **115** of FIG. 1.

(17) The surface **105** may develop the damaged portion **110** due to wear and tear, or when the surface **105** experiences an impact. For example, if the surface **105** is a drywall, the surface **105** may develop the damaged portion **110** over time, for example, when users place their hands on the drywall repeatedly or when objects (e.g., furniture, painting, electric appliances, etc.) are affixed on or in proximity to the surface **105**. As another example, the surface **105** may develop the damaged portion **110** when an object (e.g., a hammer, a toy, etc.) accidentally hits or impacts the surface **105**.

(18) In some aspects, the damaged portion **110** may include a worn area, a hole and/or a torn area, and may be of any shape and size. Further, the damaged portion **110** may be located at a surface corner edge (as shown in FIG. 1), or may be located on a surface flat portion (e.g., top portion,

bottom portion, and/or side portion).

(19) A user **120** may repair the damaged portion **110** by adhering a surface repair patch unit **125** on the surface **105** (specifically over the damaged portion **110**), and then applying a drywall compound (not shown) over a surface repair patch unit **125** exterior surface. The surface repair patch unit **125** is shown in view **130** of FIG. **1**.

(20) The user **120** may be a professional construction worker or a homeowner (or a homeowner's family member). Stated another way, the user **120** may not require professional construction expertise or skills to repair the damaged portion **110** by using the surface repair patch unit **125**.

(21) The drywall compound that may be applied over the surface repair patch unit **125** exterior surface may include, for example, any putty, spackle, mud, joint compound, plastic, resin, plaster, veneer plaster, plaster of paris, or other mixture of water, limestone, expanded perlite, ethylene-vinyl acetate polymer, gypsum, and/or attapulgite. The user **120** may also apply paint (e.g., of same color as surface **105** color) over the drywall compound to make an appearance of repaired portion same or equivalent as surface **105** appearance.

(22) The surface repair patch unit **125** may be made of one or more flexible or deformable sheets, and may include an adhesive interior surface (not shown). The surface repair patch unit **125** may be adhered to the surface **105** via the adhesive interior surface. Further, since the surface repair patch unit **125** is made of flexible/deformable sheets, the surface repair patch unit **125** may be adhered to curved surfaces or corners of drywalls (as shown in FIG. **1**), as well as flat surface portions. In this manner, the surface repair patch unit **125**, as described in the present disclosure, provides an advantage over conventional metal plate-based repair patches that may not be flexible, and hence may not have utility in repairing curved surfaces and/or drywall corners.

(23) In further aspects, the surface repair patch unit **125** may be thin (e.g., may have a thickness in a range of 0.05 to 0.2 centimeters), and hence may not visibly protrude from the surface **105** when the surface repair patch unit **125** is adhered to the surface **105**. Furthermore, the surface repair patch unit **125** may be customizable in shape and dimension, and hence may be applied to damaged portions of different lengths or widths. For example, the user **120** may customize surface repair patch unit **125** dimensions based on damaged portion **110** dimensions, by cutting the surface repair patch unit **125** using a pair of scissors. In this manner, the surface repair patch unit **125** provides an additional advantage over conventional metal plate-based repair patches that may be rigid and of standard size, and hence may not be customizable.

(24) Furthermore, the surface repair patch unit **125** may be made of one or more sheets that may have lower coefficient of thermal expansion than metal plate-based surface repair patches. Stated another way, the surface repair patch unit **125** may not expand (or contract) considerably, as compared to metal plate-based surface repair patches, when the surface repair patch unit **125** is heated (or cooled). Thus, the surface repair patch unit **125** may not develop cracks on repaired drywall portion over time, due to fluctuations in ambient temperature.

(25) The surface repair patch unit **125** may also have low modulus of elasticity, so that the user **120** may conveniently stretch (if required) the surface repair patch unit **125**. The surface repair patch unit **125** may also have “memory”, such that the surface repair patch unit **125** may return to its original shape after the surface repair patch unit **125** is stretched. For example, if the user **120** “presses inwards” the surface repair patch unit **125** into a hole (e.g., the damaged portion **110**) after adhering the surface repair patch unit **125** over the hole, the surface repair patch unit **125** may return to its original shape after the user **120** releases pressing force.

(26) Structural and functional details of the surface repair patch unit **125** are described below in detail in conjunction with subsequent figures.

(27) FIG. **2** depicts an example surface repair patch unit **200** in accordance with the present disclosure. The surface repair patch unit **200** may be same as the surface repair patch unit **125** described in conjunction with FIG. **1**. While describing FIG. **2**, references may be made to FIGS. **3A** and **3B**.

(28) The surface repair patch unit **200** may include a deformable sheet **205** (e.g., a deformable first sheet) and a deformable mesh sheet **210** (e.g., a deformable second sheet). In some aspects, the deformable sheet **205** may have a lower coefficient of thermal expansion than respective coefficients of thermal expansion of the deformable mesh sheet **210** and the surface **105**. In a preferred aspect, the deformable sheet **205** may be made of Thermoplastic Polyurethane (TPU). In other aspects, the deformable sheet **205** may be made of any other thermoplastic polyester, for example, Polylactic acid or Polylactide (PLA). Hereinafter, the deformable sheet **205** is referred to as TPU sheet **205**.

(29) Since the TPU sheet **205** may have a low coefficient of thermal expansion, the TPU sheet **205** may not expand (or contract) considerably when there are fluctuations in temperature. For example, the TPU sheet **205** may not considerably expand when the TPU sheet **205** is heated due to changes in ambient temperature. In an exemplary aspect, the TPU sheet **205** may have a coefficient of thermal expansion in a range of 10 to 30 $\mu\text{m}/\text{m}\cdot\text{K}$ (or $10.\text{sup.}-6/\text{K}$) across a wide range of temperature spectrum, e.g., from -50 to $+125$ degree Celsius.

(30) Further, the TPU sheet **205** may have a low modulus of elasticity, and hence may be easily stretched or deformed. In an exemplary aspect, the TPU sheet **205** may have a modulus of elasticity in a range of 0.005 to 0.3 gigapascals (GPa). Further, the TPU sheet **205** may have a “memory”, such that the TPU sheet **205** may return to its original shape when the TPU sheet **205** is deformed, as described in conjunction with FIG. 1.

(31) In further aspects, the TPU sheet **205** may be thin, having a uniform thickness in a range of 0.025 to 0.1 centimeter. Since the TPU sheet **205** is thin, the TPU sheet **205** is light in weight, easy to carry and may be easily cut by a pair of scissors to customize TPU sheet **205** dimensions (length and/or width).

(32) A person ordinarily skilled in the art may appreciate that the example thickness and numerical values of coefficients described above are not intended to be limiting, and the TPU sheet **205** may have different dimensions and/or coefficients, without departing from the present disclosure scope.

(33) In accordance with an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure, the deformable mesh sheet **210** may be a flat woven sheet made of fibrous material including, but not limited to, carbon nanofibers, carbon fiber, spandex, chopped fiber, fiber mat, fiberglass, textile, and/or the like. In a preferred aspect, the deformable mesh sheet **210** is made of fiberglass.

(34) The deformable mesh sheet **210** may include a mesh sheet exterior surface **215** and a mesh sheet interior surface (not shown) opposite to the mesh sheet exterior surface **215**. In some aspects, the deformable mesh sheet **210** may be an adhesive deformable mesh sheet that may be configured to be adhered to the TPU sheet **205** and the surface **105**. Specifically, the mesh sheet interior surface may include adhesive material (e.g., industrial grade adhesive), such that the deformable mesh sheet **210** (hereinafter referred to as deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210**) may be configured to be adhered to a TPU sheet first (exterior) surface **220** that may face the mesh sheet interior surface. The mesh sheet interior surface may further enable the user **120** to adhere the surface repair patch unit **200** to the surface **105**.

(35) In some aspects, the deformable mesh sheet **210** may also be thin, and may have a thickness equivalent to TPU sheet thickness. In further aspects, deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** length and/or width may be greater than TPU sheet **205** length and/or width. The user **120** may adhere the surface repair patch unit **200** to the surface **105** by using portions of the mesh sheet interior surface that may extend beyond the TPU sheet first surface **220**. Specifically, if the TPU sheet **205** has dimensions of 4*4 inch.^{sup.2} and the adhesive deformable mesh sheet **210** has dimensions of 5*5 inch.^{sup.2}, the 1 inch (i.e., 5 inches-4 inches) length and width of the mesh sheet **210** that extends beyond TPU sheet **205** area may be used by the user **120** to adhere the surface repair patch unit **200** to the surface **105**.

(36) The mesh sheet interior surface may be adhered (e.g., permanently affixed) to the TPU sheet first surface **220** by using the adhesive material (e.g., during manufacturing of the surface repair

patch unit **200**). The user **120** may apply the surface repair patch unit **200** to the surface **105** such that the TPU sheet **205** (specifically, a TPU sheet **205** second (interior) surface that is opposite to the TPU sheet first surface **220**) substantially covers the damaged portion **110**. An example snapshot of the surface repair patch unit **200** adhered to the surface **105** is shown in FIG. 3A. Specifically, FIG. 3A depicts an example isometric view of the surface **105** with the surface repair patch unit **200** adhered over the damaged portion **110**. As shown in FIG. 3A, the TPU sheet **205** may substantially cover the damaged portion **110**.

(37) As described above in conjunction with FIG. 1, the user **120** may apply drywall compound (and paint) over the surface repair patch unit **200**, when the surface repair patch unit **200** is adhered over the damaged portion **110**. As shown in FIG. 3A (and described above), the surface repair patch unit **200** may be thin and may not protrude substantially from the surface **105**. Further, as described above, the TPU sheet **205** (and hence the surface repair patch unit **200**) may have memory, such that the surface repair patch unit **200** may return to its original shape when the user **120** presses or deforms the surface repair patch unit **200**.

(38) FIG. 3B depicts an example snapshot of a surface repair patch unit **200** memory feature in accordance with the present disclosure. As shown in FIG. 3B, the user **120** may press the surface repair patch unit **200** when or after the surface repair patch unit **200** is adhered to the surface **105**. The surface repair patch unit **200** may return of its original shape (that may be same as the shape shown in FIG. 3A) after the user **120** releases the pressing force. In this manner, the surface repair patch unit **200** may not develop a permanent dent when the surface repair patch unit **200** experiences an impact.

(39) Although the description above describes that the TPU sheet **205** and the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** are two separate sheets that may be adhered to each other (and FIG. 2 too depicts two separate sheets **205** and **210**), the present disclosure is not limited to the surface repair patch unit **200** having two separate sheets **205** and **210**. In some aspects, the surface repair patch unit **200** may include a unified integrated sheet (shown as unified integrated sheet **415** in FIG. 4) that may be formed by fusing the TPU sheet **205** and the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210**. Specifically, in this case, the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** may be fused with the TPU sheet **205** to form the unified integrated sheet during the surface repair patch unit **200** manufacturing process. The deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** may be fused with the TPU sheet **205** by known fusing techniques, for example, fiberglass molding, hot welding, etc.

(40) The unified integrated sheet may provide more symbiotic relationship between the surface repair patch unit **200** and the surface **105**, when the surface repair patch unit **200** is adhered to the surface **105**. Specifically, probability of TPU sheet **205** “moving” relative to the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** and/or the surface **105** with time may be greatly reduced when the TPU sheet **205** and the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** are fused together to form the unified integrated sheet. Further, fusing the TPU sheet **205** and the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** may enable manufacturing of a thinner surface repair patch unit, as compared to surface repair patch unit **200** thickness when the surface repair patch unit **200** includes two separates sheets **205** and **210** adhered together using the adhesive material.

(41) In further aspects, when the TPU sheet **205** and the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** are fused together to form the unified integrated sheet, the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** length and/or width may be same as or equivalent to the TPU sheet **205** length and/or width. In this case, one surface (e.g., a first surface) of the unified integrated sheet may include the adhesive material and the second surface may be non-adhesive. The user **120** may adhere the unified integrated sheet to the surface **105** by using the first surface including the adhesive material. Further, similar to the TPU sheet **205**, in this case too, the unified integrated sheet may substantially cover the damaged portion **110**.

(42) In another aspect, surface repair patch unit may not include the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210**, and may only include a TPU sheet (e.g., a TPU sheet having a thickness greater than the

TPU sheet **205** thickness). In this case, the “thick” TPU sheet may include the adhesive material, and may directly adhere to the surface **105**. A surface repair patch unit without a deformable adhesive mesh sheet is described later in the description below in conjunction with FIG. 5.

(43) FIG. 4 depicts examples of packaged surface repair patch units in accordance with the present disclosure. Specifically, FIG. 4 depicts a surface repair patch unit **405** and a surface repair patch unit roll **410**. The surface repair patch unit **405** may be same as the surface repair patch unit **200**, and may include a unified integrated sheet **415** that may be formed by fusing the TPU sheet **205** and the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210**.

(44) In an exemplary aspect, the surface repair patch unit **405** may be packaged (and, for example, transported) as a stack of pre-cut multiple surface repair patch units placed one over another. Further, the TPU sheet **205** and the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** (and hence the unified integrated sheet **415**) may be pre-cut to have a square shape, and may have a length and width in a range of 4 to 8 inches. In a preferred aspect, the TPU sheet **205** and the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** (and hence the unified integrated sheet **415**) may be square-shaped with dimensions of 4*4 inch.sup.2. In other aspects, the TPU sheet **205** and the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** (and hence the unified integrated sheet **415**) may have dimensions of 6*6 inch.sup.2 or 8*8 inch.sup.2.

(45) | The surface repair patch unit **405** may further include a first protective film **420** and a second protective film **425**. In some aspects, the first and second protective films **420**, **425** may be transparent acrylic adhesive films that may be disposed over and removably adhered to opposing surfaces of the unified integrated sheet **415**. In other aspects, the first protective film **420** may be transparent and the second protective film **425** may be opaque (or vice-versa). Further, the first and second protective films **420**, **425** may have same lengths and widths that may be in a range of 4 to 10 inches. In a preferred aspect, when the TPU sheet **205** and the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** (and hence the unified integrated sheet **415**) have dimensions of 4*4 inch.sup.2, the first and second protective films **420**, **425** may have a length of 5.25 inches and a width of 4 inches.

(46) The first protective film **420** may be disposed on non-adhesive surface of the unified integrated sheet **415**, and may protect the non-adhesive surface from ambient environment. Further, the second protective film **425** may be disposed on the adhesive surface of the unified integrated sheet **415**, and may protect the adhesive surface from ambient environment.

(47) | In operation, the user **120** may remove the second protective film **425** from the surface repair patch unit **405** to expose the adhesive surface, may apply the surface repair patch unit **405** (e.g., the unified integrated sheet **415**) to the surface **105** via the adhesive surface. Further, the user **120** may remove the first protective film **420** from the surface repair patch unit **405** to expose the non-adhesive surface, and may apply the drywall compound on the non-adhesive surface of the unified integrated sheet **415** when the first protective film **420** is removed and when the unified integrated sheet **415** is adhered to the surface **105**.

(48) In the aspect (not shown in FIG. 4) where the surface repair patch unit **405** has the TPU sheet **205** and the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** attached to each other (and not fused together), the first protective film **420** may be disposed on the mesh sheet exterior surface **215** and may protect the mesh sheet exterior surface **215** from ambient environment. Further, in this case, the second protective film **425** may be disposed on the TPU sheet **210** second surface and portions of mesh sheet interior surface that extend beyond the TPU sheet **210** second surface, and may protect respective surfaces from ambient environment.

(49) The surface repair patch unit roll **410** may include an elongated surface repair patch unit that may be similar to the surface repair patch unit **405**, however surface repair patch unit **405** length in this case may be considerably greater than surface repair patch unit **405** width. For example, in this case, the surface repair patch unit **405** width may be 4 inches, however the length may be 8 feet, 10 feet, 12 feet, or the like. Since the surface repair patch unit **405** is made of deformable and flexible sheets (e.g., the TPU sheet **205** and the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210**), the surface repair

patch unit **405** may be easily rolled and packaged as the surface repair patch unit roll **410**.

(50) In this case, in operation, the user **120** may unroll the surface repair patch unit **405** from the surface repair patch unit roll **410** for a desired length, and may cut the surface repair patch unit **405** by using a pair of scissors. For example, if the user **120** desires to apply the surface repair patch unit **405** along an elongated damaged edge of drywall having a length of 12 inches, the user **120** may unroll 12 inches of the surface repair patch unit **405** from the surface repair patch unit roll **410** and may cut the required length by using a pair of scissors.

(51) In some aspects, the surface repair patch unit roll **410** may also include the first and second protective films **420**, **425**. In this case as well, the user **120** may remove the first and second protective films **420**, **425** from respective adhesive and non-adhesive surfaces of the surface repair patch unit **405**, before using the surface repair patch unit **405** to repair the damaged portion **110**.

(52) Although FIG. 4 depicts examples where the surface repair patch unit **405** is square or rectangle-shaped, the present disclosure is not limited to these shapes. In some aspects, the surface repair patch unit **405** may have other shapes, e.g., circular, oval, pentagonal, hexagonal, etc.

(53) FIG. 5 depicts an example surface patch unit **500** (or patch unit **500**) in accordance with the present disclosure. The patch unit **500** may include a TPU sheet **505** that may be similar to the TPU sheet **205**, and may have same or similar structural features as the TPU sheet **205**. In some aspects, the TPU sheet **505** may have a greater thickness than the TPU sheet **205** thickness. For example, TPU sheet **505** thickness may be 1.5 to 4 times greater than the TPU sheet **205** thickness.

(54) The TPU sheet **505** may include a first surface **510** and a second surface (e.g., an interior surface, not shown) opposite to the first surface **510**. The second surface may include the adhesive material, and may be configured to be adhered to the surface **105** (e.g., over the damaged portion **110**). In some aspects, the first surface **510** may be non-adhesive. In this case, the TPU sheet **505** may itself act as a surface repair patch (without requiring any deformable mesh sheet) and may directly adhere to the surface **105** by using the second surface. Further, in this case, the user **120** may apply drywall compound over the first surface **510** (i.e., the non-adhesive surface) when the TPU sheet **505** is adhered to the surface **105**.

(55) In other aspects, the first surface **510** too may include adhesive material. In this case, the patch unit **500** may additionally include a textile sheet **515** that may be attached (e.g., permanently affixed) to the first surface **510**. The textile sheet **515** may include a textile exterior surface **520** and a textile interior surface (not shown) that may be opposite to the textile exterior surface **520**. The textile sheet **515** may be attached to the first surface **510** via the textile interior surface. The textile sheet **515** may be made of, for example, cotton, silk, wool, linen, synthetic fibers such as rayon, nylon, polyester, and/or the like.

(56) In some aspects, the textile sheet **515** may have water-repellant properties, so that the textile sheet **515** may not retain water. In other aspects, the textile sheet **515** may further include Hydrochromic ink, such that the textile sheet **515** may change color when the textile sheet **515** is wet.

(57) The textile sheet **515** may have same dimensions (e.g., length and width) as the TPU sheet **505**, or may have lesser or greater dimensions than TPU sheet **505** dimensions. Further, a textile sheet **515** thickness may be same as TPU sheet **505** thickness, or the textile sheet **515** thickness may be greater than the TPU sheet **505** thickness. In a preferred aspect, the textile sheet **515** thickness is greater than the TPU sheet **505** thickness. For example, the textile sheet **515** thickness may be in a range of 5 to 25 times greater than the TPU sheet **505** thickness.

(58) In an exemplary aspect, the patch unit **500** may be adhered to surface or drywall corners, and the patch unit **500** may act as a childproof surface patch. Specifically, since the textile sheet **515** thickness is considerably greater than the TPU sheet **505** thickness, the patch unit **500** may provide “cushion” on the surface or drywall corners, and may thus act as a childproof surface patch. The textile exterior surface **520** may further include decorative pictures, images (e.g., action hero images, toy images, cartoon creature images, etc.) for aesthetic purposes.

(59) In the aspect described above, the patch unit **500** may be applied over the damaged portion **110**, and may also be applied to surfaces or corners that may not be damaged, however may be prone to repeated impacts (e.g., by users or children). The user **120** may adhere the patch unit **500** (including the thick textile sheet **515**) to such surfaces to “child-proof” the surfaces. Further, since the textile sheet **515** includes Hydrochromic ink, the user **120** may get an indication when the textile sheet **515** (and hence the patch unit **500**) may be wet. The user **120** may accordingly dry the surface/patch unit **500** (or take appropriate action) to avoid damage to the surface **105**.

(60) The patch unit **500** may additionally include the first and second protective films **420**, **425** (not shown in FIG. 5) that may be removably adhered to opposing surfaces of the patch unit **500**. As described above, the first and second protective films **420**, **425** may protect respective patch unit **500** surfaces from ambient environment, and the user **120** may remove the first and second protective films **420**, **425** from the patch unit **500** surface before adhering the patch unit **500** to the surface **105**. A snapshot of the patch unit **500** adhered to the surface **105** is shown as view **525** in FIG. 5.

(61) In additional aspects, the patch unit **500** may include one or more additional reinforcement sheets or layers (not shown) disposed between the textile sheet **515** and the TPU sheet **505**. The reinforcement sheets or layers may be used to provide additional cushion to the childproof surface patch and increase patch unit **500** thickness. For example, the reinforcement sheets or layers may include layers of flexible plastic or foam.

(62) In yet another aspect, the patch unit **500** may also include the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** attached to the TPU sheet **505**, or include the unified integrated sheet **415** instead of the TPU sheet **505**. In this case, the textile sheet and/or the reinforcement sheets may be attached to the deformable adhesive mesh sheet **210** or the unified integrated sheet **415**.

(63) In the above disclosure, reference has been made to the accompanying drawings, which form a part hereof, which illustrate specific implementations in which the present disclosure may be practiced. It is understood that other implementations may be utilized, and structural changes may be made without departing from the scope of the present disclosure. References in the specification to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” “an example embodiment,” etc., indicate that the embodiment described may include a particular feature, structure, or characteristic, but every embodiment may not necessarily include the particular feature, structure, or characteristic. Moreover, such phrases are not necessarily referring to the same embodiment. Further, when a feature, structure, or characteristic is described in connection with an embodiment, one skilled in the art will recognize such feature, structure, or characteristic in connection with other embodiments whether or not explicitly described.

(64) It should also be understood that the word “example” as used herein is intended to be non-exclusionary and non-limiting in nature. More particularly, the word “example” as used herein indicates one among several examples, and it should be understood that no undue emphasis or preference is being directed to the particular example being described.

(65) With regard to the processes, systems, methods, heuristics, etc. described herein, it should be understood that, although the steps of such processes, etc. have been described as occurring according to a certain ordered sequence, such processes could be practiced with the described steps performed in an order other than the order described herein. It further should be understood that certain steps could be performed simultaneously, that other steps could be added, or that certain steps described herein could be omitted. In other words, the descriptions of processes herein are provided for the purpose of illustrating various embodiments and should in no way be construed so as to limit the claims.

(66) Accordingly, it is to be understood that the above description is intended to be illustrative and not restrictive. Many embodiments and applications other than the examples provided would be apparent upon reading the above description. The scope should be determined, not with reference to the above description, but should instead be determined with reference to the appended claims,

along with the full scope of equivalents to which such claims are entitled. It is anticipated and intended that future developments will occur in the technologies discussed herein, and that the disclosed systems and methods will be incorporated into such future embodiments. In sum, it should be understood that the application is capable of modification and variation.

(67) All terms used in the claims are intended to be given their ordinary meanings as understood by those knowledgeable in the technologies described herein unless an explicit indication to the contrary is made herein. In particular, use of the singular articles such as “a,” “the,” “said,” etc., should be read to recite one or more of the indicated elements unless a claim recites an explicit limitation to the contrary. Conditional language, such as, among others, “can,” “could,” “might,” or “may,” unless specifically stated otherwise, or otherwise understood within the context as used, is generally intended to convey that certain embodiments could include, while other embodiments may not include, certain features, elements, and/or steps. Thus, such conditional language is not generally intended to imply that features, elements, and/or steps are in any way required for one or more embodiments.

Claims

1. A surface repair patch unit comprising: a deformable first sheet having a first sheet interior surface and a first sheet exterior surface, wherein the deformable first sheet is made of Thermoplastic Polyurethane (TPU); and a deformable second sheet attached with the deformable first sheet, wherein the deformable second sheet comprises an adhesive mesh sheet, wherein: the deformable second sheet comprises a second sheet interior surface and a second sheet exterior surface, the first sheet exterior surface is attached to the second sheet interior surface, the first sheet interior surface is configured to be adhered to a damaged surface, the deformable first sheet having the TPU is configured to directly contact the damaged surface, and wherein a coefficient of thermal expansion of the deformable first sheet is lower than respective coefficients of thermal expansion of the deformable second sheet and the damaged surface.
2. The surface repair patch unit of claim 1, wherein a deformable first sheet length is in a range of 4 to 8 inches, and wherein a deformable first sheet width is in a range of 4 to 8 inches.
3. The surface repair patch unit of claim 2, wherein the deformable first sheet length is less than a deformable second sheet length, and wherein the deformable first sheet width is less than a deformable second sheet width.
4. The surface repair patch unit of claim 1, wherein a deformable first sheet length is 4 inches, and wherein a deformable first sheet width is 4 inches.
5. The surface repair patch unit of claim 1, wherein the surface repair patch unit is packaged as a roll.
6. The surface repair patch unit of claim 1, wherein the deformable second sheet is made of fibrous material.
7. The surface repair patch unit of claim 6, wherein the fibrous material is fiberglass.
8. The surface repair patch unit of claim 1 further comprising a first protective film disposed on the first sheet interior surface and portions of the second sheet interior surface, wherein the first protective film is configured to protect the first sheet interior surface and the portions of the second sheet interior surface from ambient environment.
9. The surface repair patch unit of claim 1 further comprising a second protective film disposed on the second sheet exterior surface, wherein the second protective film is configured to protect the second sheet exterior surface from ambient environment.
10. The surface repair patch unit of claim 1, wherein the deformable first sheet has a memory such that the deformable first sheet may return to its original shape when the deformable first sheet is deformed.
11. A surface repair patch unit comprising: a deformable Thermoplastic Polyurethane (TPU) sheet;

- and a deformable adhesive mesh sheet fused with the TPU sheet to form a unified integrated sheet, and wherein the unified integrated sheet is configured to be adhered to a damaged surface.
12. The surface repair patch unit of claim 11, wherein a TPU sheet length is in a range of 4 to 8 inches, and wherein a TPU sheet width is in a range of 4 to 8 inches.
13. The surface repair patch unit of claim 11, wherein a TPU sheet length is 4 inches, and wherein a TPU sheet width is 4 inches.
14. The surface repair patch unit of claim 11, wherein the surface repair patch unit is packaged as a roll.
15. The surface repair patch unit of claim 11, wherein the deformable adhesive mesh sheet is made of fibrous material.
16. The surface repair patch unit of claim 15, wherein the fibrous material is fiberglass.
17. A patch unit comprising: a deformable Thermoplastic Polyurethane (TPU) sheet having adhesive material at a TPU sheet interior surface; and a textile sheet attached to a TPU sheet exterior surface, wherein a textile sheet thickness is greater than a TPU sheet thickness, and wherein the patch unit is configured to be adhered to a surface via the TPU sheet interior surface.
18. The patch unit of claim 17, wherein a TPU sheet length is in a range of 2 to 7 inches, and wherein a TPU sheet width is in a range of 4 to 8 inches.
19. The patch unit of claim 17 further comprising a reinforcement sheet disposed between the TPU sheet and the textile sheet.
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